23 Minutes in Hell

By Bill Wiese

INTRODUCTION

Hell is a place of desolation, agony, and never-ending suffering. It is everything God is not, because God is truly absent from that place. In this book, we hear a man's account of what he truly saw and felt in this place of torment.

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On Sunday, November 22, 1998 my wife, Annette and I spent the evening at the home of one of our closest friends. There was nothing unusual about that night. Annette and I headed home around 11:00 PM, and we fell into bed shortly before midnight, unaware that my life was about to be changed forever by an event I still find hard to explain. Suddenly at 3:00 AM on the 23rd, without any notice, I found myself being hurled through the air and then was falling to the ground completely out of control.

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I landed in what appeared to be a prison cell. The walls of the cell were made out of a roughhewn stone and had a door made what appeared to be thick metal bars. I was completely naked which added to the vulnerability of a captive. This was not a dream - I realized I was actually in the strange place fully awake and cognizant. I had no idea what happened, how I had traveled, or why I was there until it was shown to me and explained later during my journey.

As I lay there on the floor of that cell, I felt extremely weak. I noticed I had a body; one appeared just as it is now. Lifting my head, I began to look around, immediately I realized that I was not alone in the cell. I saw two enormous beasts unlike anything I've ever seen before. These creatures were approximately 10 to 13 feet tall. These towering beasts were far, far beyond intimidating. It is one thing to be threatened by someone much taller than you. But these creatures were not of this natural world. I recognize that they were entirely evil, and were gazing at me with pure, unrestrained hatred, which completely paralyzed me with fear. 'Evil' and 'Terror' stood before me. Those creatures were on intensely concentrated

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manifestation of those 2 forces. The creatures weren't animals, but they weren't human either. Each giant beast resembled a reptile in appearance but took on human form. Their arms and legs were unequal in length, out of proportion – without symmetry. The first one had bones and scales all over its grotesque body. It had a huge protruding jaw, gigantic teeth, and large sunken-in eyes. This creature was stout and powerful with big legs abnormally large feet. It was pacing violently around the cell like a caged bull, and its demeanor was extremely ferocious. The second beast was taller and thinner with very long arms and razor-sharp fins that covered its body. Protruding from its hands were claws that were nearly a foot long. Its personality seemed different from the first being. It was certainly no less evil but it remained a rather still.

One of the creatures picked me up. The strength of the beast was amazing. I was comparable to the weight of a water glass in its hand. Then the beast threw me against the wall. It felt as though every bone in my body had been broken. The second beast with its razor like claws and sharp protruding fins then grabbed me from behind. As it

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pressed me into its chest, its sharp fins pierced my back. I knew that I could not escape this torture via death for not even that was an option. Death penetrated me but eluded me. No mercy existed in that place. Mercy is from God in heaven.

I was extremely nauseous from that terrible foul stench coming from these creatures. It was absolutely disgusting, foul, and rotten. If you could take every rotten thing you can imagine such as an open sewer, sour milk, rotting flesh, and sulfur, and magnify it 1000 times you might come close. The odor was extremely toxic and that alone should have killed me.

Somehow, I managed to move a bit and dragged myself across the ground toward the barred door. I finally made it to the door and crawled out of the cell. Apparently, the creatures allowed me to crawl out without stopping me.

All I could think of was to get up onto my feet. However, every move to get up took great effort. I remember wondering "Why is this so difficult'? After tremendous exertion, I was finally able to stand. I was thoroughly

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exhausted, and, at the same time, very frustrated at how hard simple movement had become.

I was horrified as I heard the screams of an untold multitude of people crying out in torment. Through the panic and the deafening noise, I struggled to gather my thoughts. "I'm in hell! This is a real place, and I'm actually here!" I frantically tried to understand, but it was just so inconceivable. This place was so terrifying, so intense, and so hostile that it would be impossible for me to exaggerate the horror.

As I stood outside the cell, I actually felt the darkness. It was not like the darkness on earth. I was once in a coal mine in Arizona that was completely void of light. I couldn't see anything, yet it was nothing like the darkness in hell. It was as though the darkness had its own power, a power that consumed me. The darkness was not simply the absence of light—it had a distinctive evil presence, a feeling of death, of penetrating evil.

I looked off to my right and could faintly see flames from afar off that dimly lit the skyline. I knew the flames were coming from a large pit, a gigantic raging inferno approximately one mile in diameter and about ten miles

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away. This was just one of the many things I simply knew. My senses were keener.

The only visible area was that which the flames exposed. The ground was all rock, barren and desolate. There was not one green thing, not one living thing, not one blade of grass, not one leaf on the ground—it was just a complete wasteland.

The air was filled with smoke, and a filthy, deathly, decaying odor hung in the oxygen-depleted atmosphere. It seemed as if all the oxygen had been sucked up by the high leaping flames in the distance. I could barely breathe. The lack of oxygen in the atmosphere left me gasping for every little bit of air I could inhale. There was no humidity or moisture in the air. It was exhausting even to try to get just one breath.

One of the worst sensations I experienced was an insatiable thirst and dryness. I was so extremely thirsty. My mouth was so dry it felt as if I had been running through the desert for days. There was no water, no humidity in the air, no water anywhere. I desperately longed for just one drop of water.

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One of the demonic creatures grabbed me and carried me back into the cell. It threw me on the floor; when, all of a sudden, I was taken back out of the cell and placed next to that pit of fire I had viewed from a distance earlier.

Momentary relief hit my soul as I realized I had been snatched from the grip of those hideous creatures. However, now I found myself next to an enormous pit with raging flames of fire leaping high into an open cavern. As I looked up into that dark, eerie, tomb-like atmosphere, it seemed to be like a mouth that had swallowed her dead. The flames of her ravenous appetite were never satisfied with the pitiful screams of untold multitudes.

The heat was far beyond unbearable, and I desperately wanted to escape before I too would be thrown into that inferno. As I look back on this experience now, I am reminded of the devastation of the twin towers of the World Trade Center of September 11, 2001, when some people, rather than facing the 2000-degree heat, chose to plummet to their death by leaping out a window. A fall, especially from such great heights, must have been horrendous. It was reported that a person subjected to that temperature would be completely incinerated in about

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fifteen seconds. Those people chose to make that leap rather than face the intensity of those flames for even fifteen seconds. Some scientists have reported that the core temperature at the center of the earth is approximately twelve thousand degrees. To endure that for an eternity is unfathomable.

I also experienced the misery of total exhaustion in hell. The continual emotional, mental, and physical trauma feeds this vicious cycle of sleep deprivation. You desperately long for even a few minutes of rest, but you never, ever get that privilege. In hell, you never sleep, rest, or find a quiet moment. And form of rest is completely nonexistent. Even though I was only there for 23 minutes, the torment and trauma were so intense that it felt like I hadn't slept for weeks.

Now, it's true that there are areas in this vast, fiery pit where people are thrown together, but they are only 'together' in the sense that they are all experiencing the same torment. Each person is very isolated in extreme agony and screaming in fear as fire and brimstone rain down upon him. They are 'together' in the same way cattle are herded into a slaughterhouse. A soul in such extreme

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agony would have no opportunity for a conversation. Besides, I believe that everyone is just on the verge of insanity. However, I believe you never quite go insane, for that would provide a form of escape. And there is no escape, even mentally.

Suddenly, I began ascending. I didn't know how I was able to ascend or why. You see, the demons cannot harm God directly, but they can hurt His children and His creation. It saddens God to see His creation suffer. The Lord loves us and wants us to live healthy, peaceful, long lives. He wants us to warn more people about hell and to share with them just what they need to do to avoid that terrible place.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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